

API Testing Assignment

ReqRes API — Authentication, CRUD, and Automated Validation with Postman

Author: Grace UMWIZA

1. API Choice and Base URL

API used: ReqRes

Base URL: <https://reqres.in/api>

ReqRes was chosen because it provides CRUD-style endpoints with predictable, well-documented responses, making it well suited for demonstrating authentication, all HTTP verbs, environment variables, and automated testing in Postman. The /users endpoints are demo/testing fixtures, so requests return the expected HTTP status codes and response shapes rather than persisting changes to a real database.

2. Authentication Method Used

Method: API Key + Login Token

Two authentication mechanisms were demonstrated:

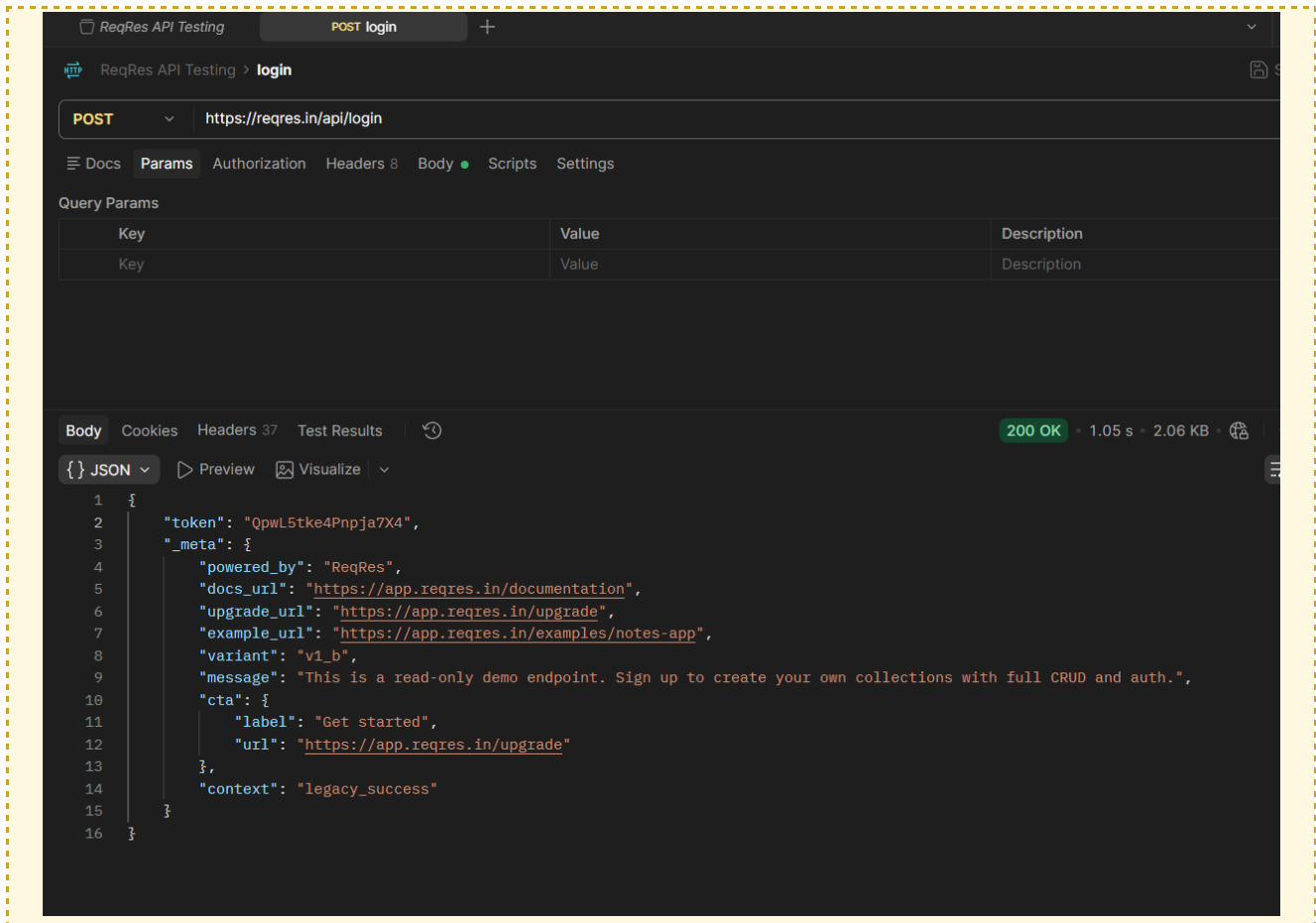
- **API key** — sent as a header on /users requests, stored in the Postman environment variable `api_key` and referenced as `{{api_key}}`. A Pre-request Script attaches it automatically:

```
pm.request.headers.upsert({
  key: "x-api-key",
  value: pm.environment.get("api_key")
});
```

- **Login token** — obtained via `POST {{base_url}}/login`. A successful response returns a bearer token, which is not hardcoded anywhere — it's captured automatically and stored in the environment variable `auth_token`.

Proof of authentication: `POST {{base_url}}/login` was sent with a valid email/password body. A 200 OK response containing a token confirms authentication is working correctly.

✱ *Login request*



3. Endpoints Tested

#	Request	Method	Endpoint	Required Headers	Purpose
1	Login	POST	/login	Content-Type: application/json	Authenticate and retrieve a bearer token
2	Get All Users	GET	/users?page=2	Authorization: Bearer {{auth_token}} x-api-key: {{api_key}}	Retrieve a list of users
3	Get Single User	GET	/users/{{user_id}}	Authorization: Bearer {{auth_token}} x-api-key: {{api_key}}	Retrieve a specific user
4	Create User	POST	/users	Authorization: Bearer {{auth_token}} x-api-key: {{api_key}}	Create a new user

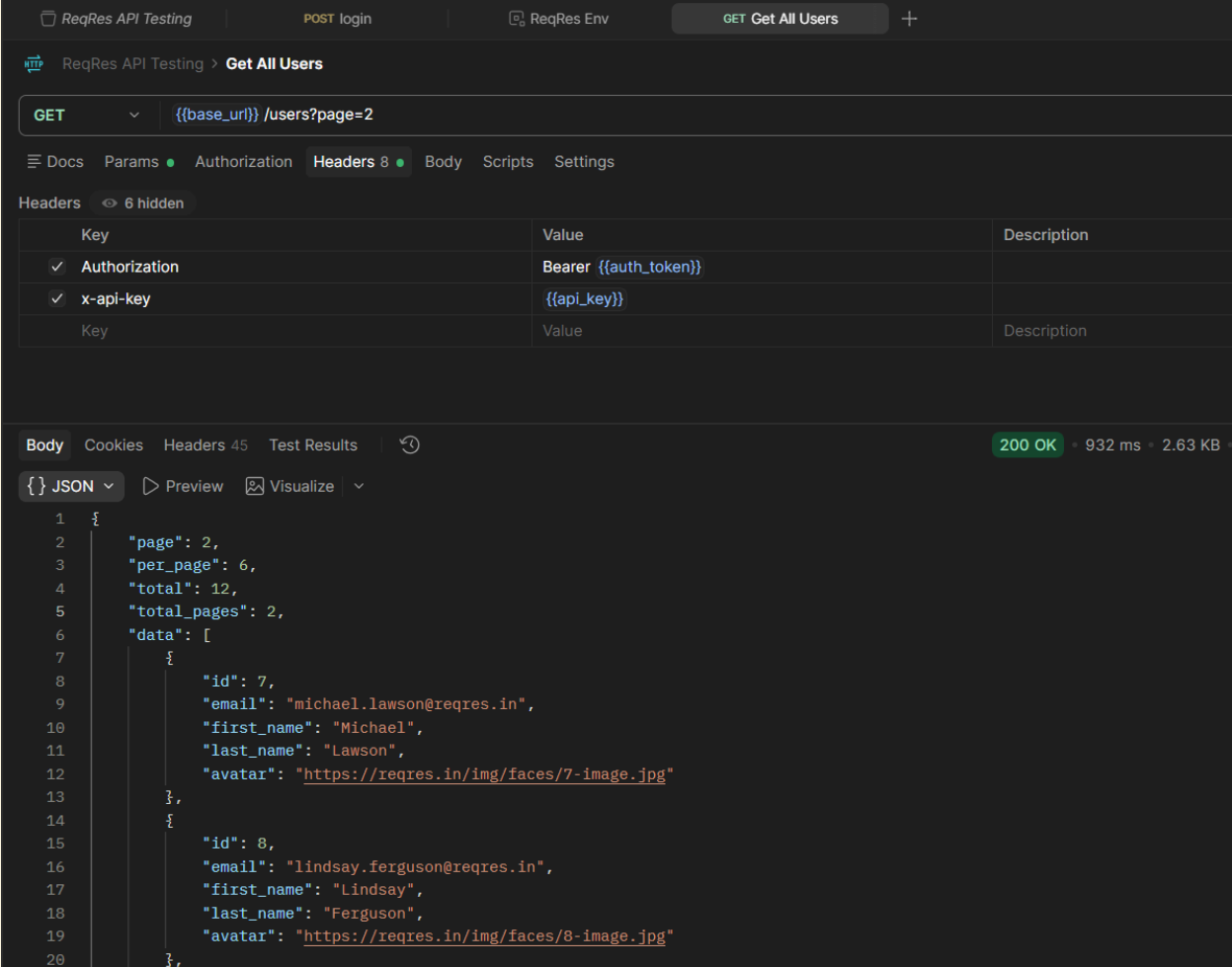
#	Request	Method	Endpoint	Required Headers	Purpose
				Content-Type: application/json	
5	Update User	PUT	/users/{{user_id}}	Authorization: Bearer {{auth_token}} x-api-key: {{api_key}} Content-Type: application/json	Fully update a user
6	Patch Update User	PATCH	/users/{{user_id}}	Authorization: Bearer {{auth_token}} x-api-key: {{api_key}} Content-Type: application/json	Partially update a user
7	Delete User	DELETE	/users/{{user_id}}	Authorization: Bearer {{auth_token}} x-api-key: {{api_key}}	Delete a user

4. CRUD Operations — Explanation and Evidence

GET — Read

GET `{{base_url}}/users?page=2` retrieves a paginated list of users and returns 200 OK. GET `{{base_url}}/users/{{user_id}}` retrieves a single user by ID, also returning 200 OK.

* GET All Users



The screenshot shows the ReqRes API Testing interface. The request is a GET to `{{base_url}}/users?page=2`. The headers tab is selected, showing `Authorization: Bearer {{auth_token}}` and `x-api-key: {{api_key}}`. The body tab is also selected, showing a JSON response with a 200 OK status, 932 ms response time, and 2.63 KB body size. The JSON response is as follows:

```
{
  "page": 2,
  "per_page": 6,
  "total": 12,
  "total_pages": 2,
  "data": [
    {
      "id": 7,
      "email": "michael.lawson@reqres.in",
      "first_name": "Michael",
      "last_name": "Lawson",
      "avatar": "https://reqres.in/img/faces/7-image.jpg"
    },
    {
      "id": 8,
      "email": "lindsay.ferguson@reqres.in",
      "first_name": "Lindsay",
      "last_name": "Ferguson",
      "avatar": "https://reqres.in/img/faces/8-image.jpg"
    }
  ]
}
```

* GET Single User

ReqRes API Testing > **Get Single User**

GET `{{base_url}}/users/{{user_id}}`

Docs Params Authorization **Headers 8** Body Scripts Settings

Headers 6 hidden

Key	Value	Description
✓ Authorization	Bearer <code>{{auth_token}}</code>	
✓ x-api-key	<code>{{api_key}}</code>	
Key	Value	Description

Body Cookies Headers 45 Test Results 200 OK • 694 ms • 2

`{{JSON}}` Preview Visualize

```

2  "data": {
3    "id": 2,
4    "email": "janet.weaver@reqres.in",
5    "first_name": "Janet",
6    "last_name": "Weaver",
7    "avatar": "https://reqres.in/img/faces/2-image.jpg"
8  },
9  "support": {
10   "url": "https://benhowdle.im/first-cto-playbook?utm_source=reqres&utm_medium=json&utm_campaign=referral",
11   "text": "Become a better CTO. A playbook of painful stories and practical advice from a two-time startup CTO."
12 },
13 "_meta": {
14   "powered_by": "ReqRes",
15   "docs_url": "https://app.reqres.in/documentation",

```

POST — Create

POST `{{base_url}}/users` creates a new user. Request body:

```

{
  "name": "morpheus",
  "job": "leader"
}

```

A successful request returns 201 Created along with the new user's id and a createdAt timestamp.

✳ *POST Create User*

The screenshot displays the ReqRes API Testing interface. At the top, a navigation bar includes links for 'ReqRes API Testing', 'POST login', 'ReqRes Env', 'GET Get All Users', 'GET Get Single User', and 'POST Create User'. The main header shows 'ReqRes API Testing > Create User'. Below this, the method 'POST' is selected, and the endpoint is set to '{{base_url}}/users'. The 'Params' tab is active, showing a table with columns 'Key', 'Value', and 'Description'. The 'Body' tab is also visible, showing a JSON response. The response status is '201 Created' with a time of '1.02 s' and a size of '2.43 KB'. The JSON body is as follows:

```

1 {
2   "name": "morpheus",
3   "job": "leader",
4   "id": "76",
5   "createdAt": "2026-09-01T19:11:33.813Z",
6   "_meta": {
7     "powered_by": "ReqRes",
8     "docs_url": "https://app.reqres.in/documentation",
9     "upgrade_url": "https://app.reqres.in/upgrade",
10    "example_url": "https://app.reqres.in/examples/notes-app",
11    "variant": "v1_b",
12    "message": "This is a read-only demo endpoint. Sign up to create your own collections with full CRUD and auth.",
13    "cta": {
14      "label": "Get started",
15      "url": "https://app.reqres.in/upgrade"
16    },
17    "context": "legacy_success"
18  }
19 }

```

PUT — Full Update

PUT `{{base_url}}/users/{{user_id}}` replaces a user's full data. A successful update returns 200 OK with the updated fields and an updatedAt timestamp.

✳ *PUT Update User*

The screenshot displays the ReqRes API Testing interface for a **PUT Update User** request. The URL is `{{base_url}}/users/{{user_id}}`. The request headers include **Authorization** (Bearer `{{auth_token}}`) and **x-api-key** (`{{api_key}}`). The response status is **200 OK** with a response time of 1.16 s and a size of 2.28 KB. The response body is shown in JSON format:

```

1  {
2    "name": "morpheus",
3    "job": "zion resident",
4    "updatedAt": "2026-09-01T19:16:44.869Z",
5    "_meta": {
6      "powered_by": "ReqRes",
7      "docs_url": "https://app.reqres.in/documentation",
8      "upgrade_url": "https://app.reqres.in/upgrade",
9      "example_url": "https://app.reqres.in/examples/notes-app",
10     "variant": "v1_b",
11     "message": "This is a read-only demo endpoint. Sign up to create your own collections with full CRUD and auth.",
12     "cta": {
13       "label": "Get started",
14       "url": "https://app.reqres.in/upgrade"
15     },
16     "context": "legacy_success"
17   }
18 }

```

PATCH — Partial Update

PATCH `{{base_url}}/users/{{user_id}}` updates only the specified field(s). Request body:

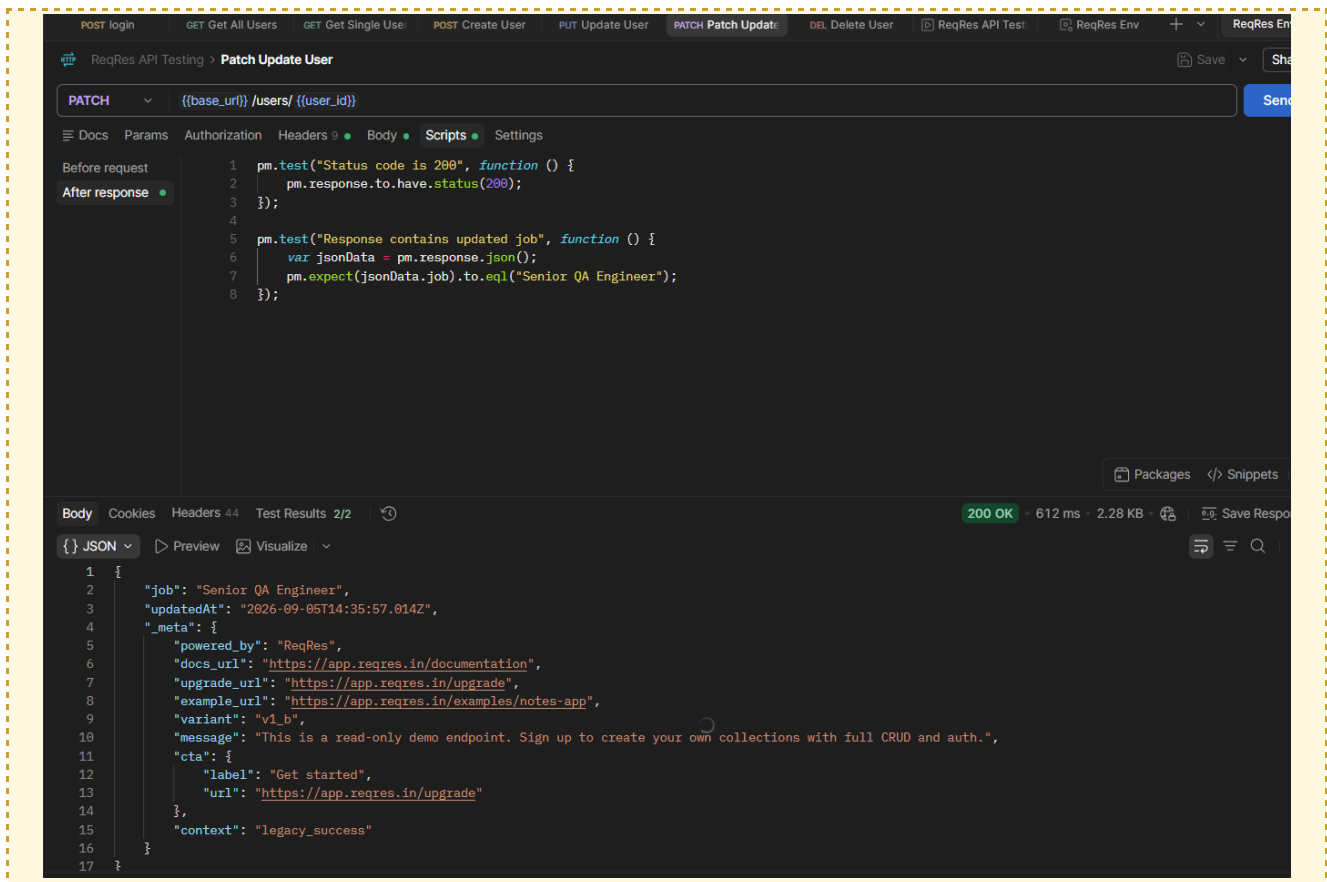
```

{
  "job": "Senior QA Engineer"
}

```

A successful update returns 200 OK, and the response confirms the updated value.

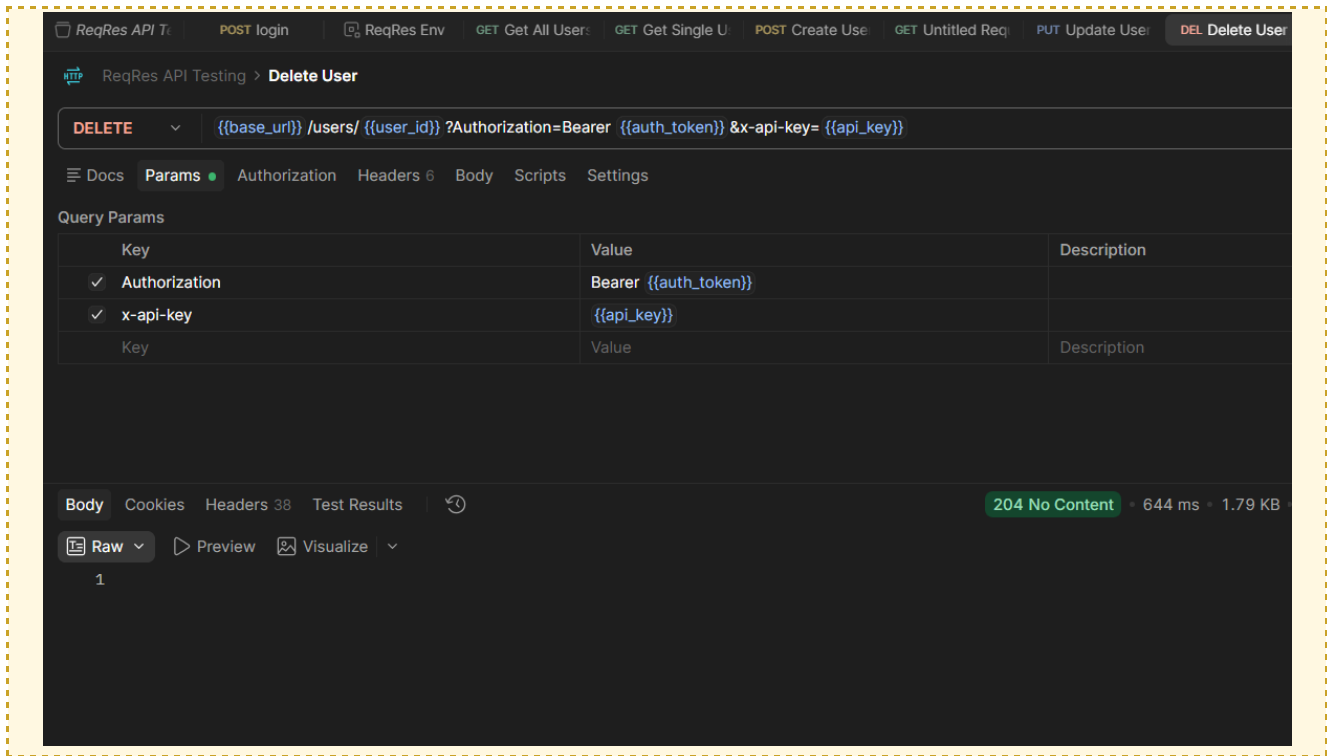
✳ *PATCH request*



DELETE — Delete

DELETE `{{base_url}}/users/{{user_id}}` removes the user. A successful deletion returns 204 No Content (an empty response body is expected and correct).

✳ *DELETE User*

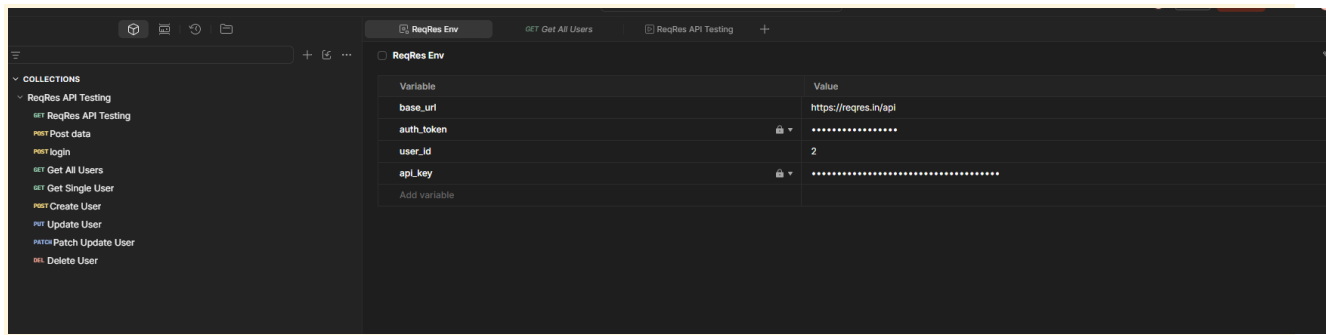


5. Environment Variables and Automation

A Postman environment named **ReqRes Env** was created to store values reused across requests instead of hardcoding them:

Variable	Purpose
base_url	https://reqres.in/api — used at the start of every request URL
auth_token	The bearer token returned from Login, used to demonstrate token-based auth
api_key	The API key used in the x-api-key header for /users requests
user_id	The ID of the user used by the Get Single User, Update, and Delete requests

✳ *ReqRes Env tab*



Automation — saving the login token automatically

Rather than manually copying the token from the Login response, a test script was added to the Login request:

```
pm.test("Status code is 200", function () {
  pm.response.to.have.status(200);
});

pm.test("Response has token", function () {
  var jsonData = pm.response.json();
  pm.expect(jsonData.token).to.exist;
});

pm.environment.set("auth_token", pm.response.json().token);
```

This automatically extracts the token field from the response and saves it into `auth_token`, so any subsequent authenticated request can use `{{auth_token}}` with no manual steps in between.

Automation — Pre-request Script

A Pre-request Script was added to the Login request to automatically attach the current API key from the environment before the request is sent (shown in Section 2).

Per-request test scripts

Test scripts were added to each request to verify correct behavior, for example on the *Patch Update User* request:

```
pm.test("Status code is 200", function () {
  pm.response.to.have.status(200);
});
```

```
pm.test("Response contains updated job", function () {  
  var jsonData = pm.response.json();  
  pm.expect(jsonData.job).to.eql("Senior QA Engineer");  
});
```

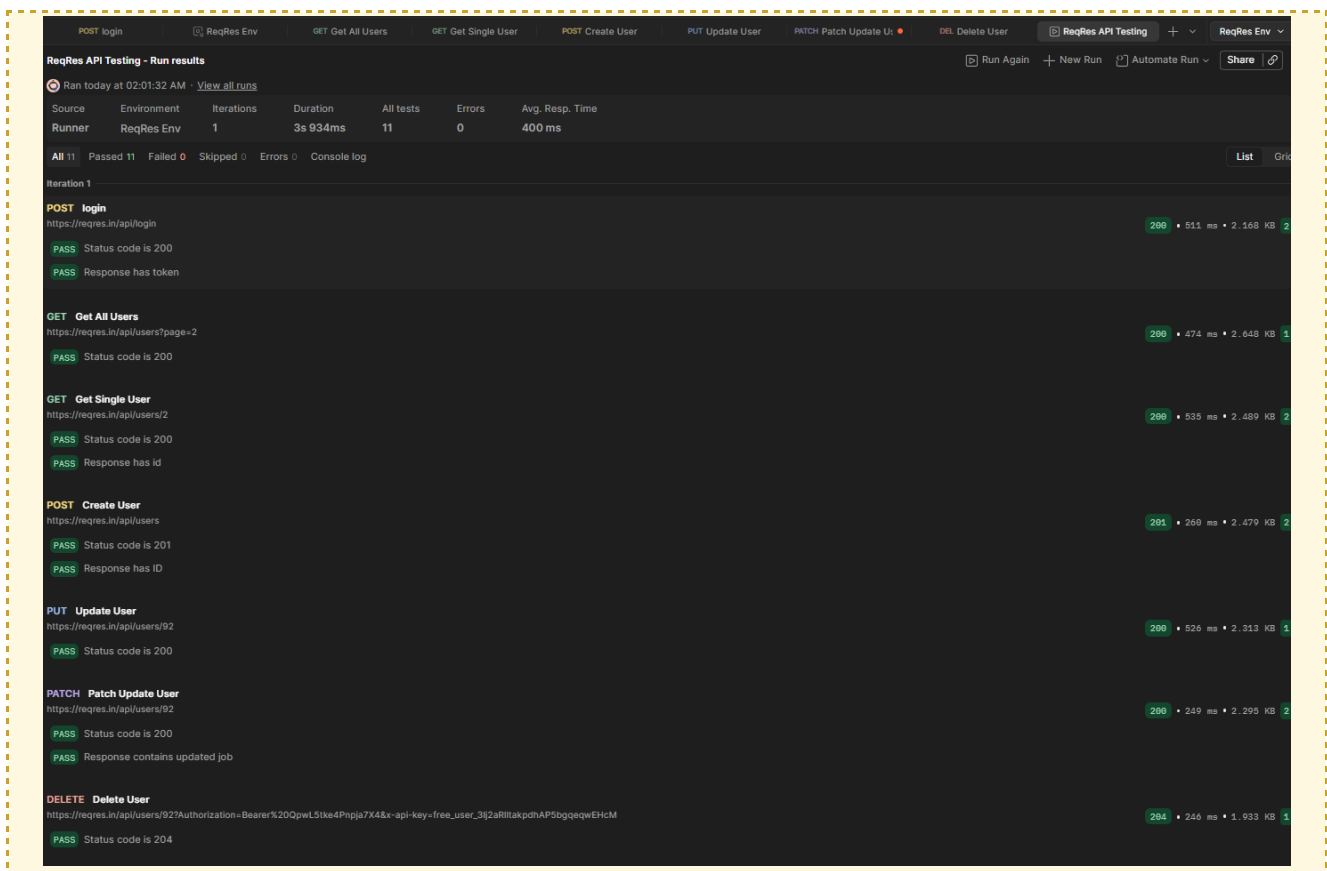
6. Collection Runner

All seven requests (Login → Get All Users → Get Single User → Create User → Update User → Patch Update User → Delete User) were grouped into a single Postman Collection and executed in sequence using the Collection Runner, with the ReqRes Env environment selected. The run completed with 11/11 tests passed and 0 failures:

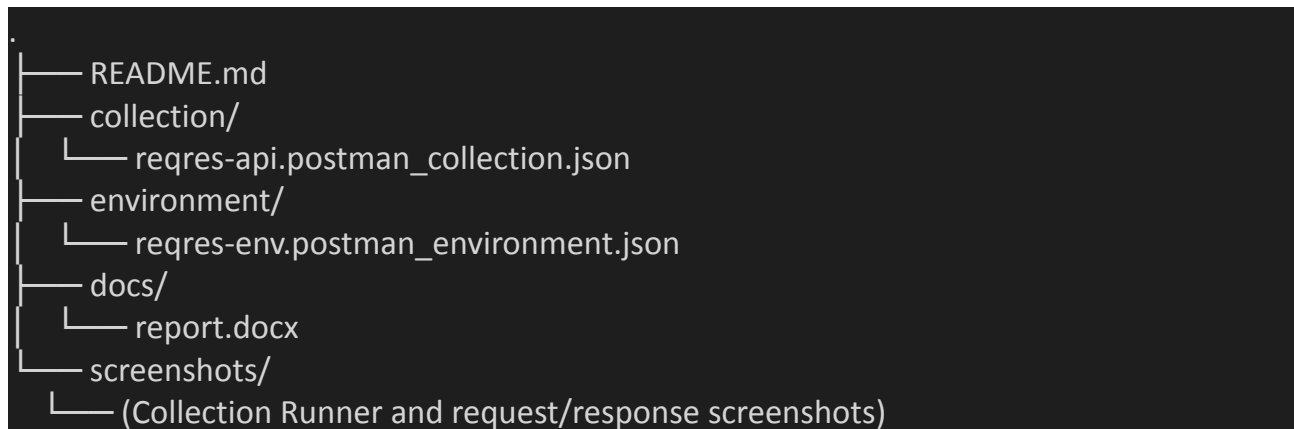
Request	Status	Test Result
Login	200	PASS
Get All Users	200	PASS
Get Single User	200	PASS
Create User	201	PASS
Update User	200	PASS
Patch Update User	200	PASS
Delete User	204	PASS

Collection Runner — 11/11 tests passed

✳ *Collection Runner summary*



7. Deliverables in This Repository



Note: The exported environment file has all values (base_url, auth_token, api_key, user_id) left empty before being committed to this repository — no real credentials are included.

Note on screenshots: Full screenshots of every request/response (authentication, GET, POST, PUT, PATCH, DELETE, environment variables, and the Collection Runner run) are included in this report and in the screenshots/ folder, alongside the repository.